GROUP WORK ETHICS AGREEMENT

CMPG 315 - GROUP 13

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Acknowledgement: This document is a binding agreement between all seven members of Group 13. It consolidates our discussions, decisions, and commitments made during our kick-off meeting on March 12, 2026, and subsequent planning sessions. By signing below, we pledge to adhere to the principles, fulfill our responsibilities, and respect the processes outlined herein to ensure the successful and collaborative completion of our network design project.

INTRODUCTION AND PURPOSE

This document outlines the agreed-upon work ethics, expectations, and responsibilities for all 7 members of Group 13 for the duration of this network design project. The purpose of this agreement is to ensure that we successfully deliver a cost-effective, functional network design that meets all client requirements while working together professionally and respectfully.

CORE PRINCIPLES

These foundational values will guide our interactions and work throughout the project.

- **Respect and Inclusivity**: Treat all members with professionalism. No discrimination based on background, gender, or academic performance. Respect differing opinions and working styles.
- **Quality Contributions**: Contributions must be thoughtful and advance the project, not just minimal effort. Simulations and configurations should not be copied from external sources without understanding them.
- **Transparency**: Share progress openly; no hidden work or last-minute surprises. Communicate openly about challenges or delays immediately.
- **Commitment**: Every member is expected to contribute their fair share of the workload and uphold the quality standards set by the group. All members should also seek to learn and grow their technical skills throughout the project.

GROUP ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

To ensure clarity and accountability, the following roles have been established. These roles are collaborative, but the primary responsibilities are assigned to specific individuals.

Role	Responsibilities	Assigned Members

Group Leaders	- Kgaugelo: Track completed tasks, ensure all members submit their parts, and submit Phase 2 and Phase 3 documents on eFundi. - Ahleli: Facilitate meetings and ensure all 7 voices are heard. - Both: Monitor progress against the project timeline, act as the primary liaison with the instructor, and monitor group dynamics	Kgaugelo Mabote & Ahleli Pilingane
Network Designer Lead	Lead the Packet Tracer design; ensure all technical requirements are met; oversee all technical implementation.	F Mabaso
Assistant Network Designer	Support the Network Designer Lead and work on specific sections of the Packet Tracer.	TP Motau
Cost Analyst & Researcher	Research solutions and find cost-saving opportunities for the network design.	AER Baloyi & P Tshoeu
Documentation Lead & Report Compiler	Write minutes of meetings; compile all sections into a cohesive final report; ensure professional formatting and presentation; manage document versions.	LBT Mogatusi
GitHub Manager & Quality Reviewer	Ensure every member contributes to the GitHub repository. Review contributions for quality and consistency.	Kgaugelo Mabote & Ahleli Pilingane

Every member is expected to:

- Fulfill the responsibilities of their primary role.
- Attend all scheduled meetings or provide notice of absence at least 24 hours in advance.
- Complete assigned tasks by agreed-upon dates.
- Contribute to a positive and supportive team environment.
- Familiarise themselves with "GITHUB" and how it works.
- Help other roles when their own tasks are completed early.

- Review each other's work and support the team beyond their primary role.
- No member should delete or overwrite another member's work without discussion.

MEETING PROTOCOLS

Schedule and Format

- Regular Meetings: Weekly in-person meetings (1-3 hours) on Thursdays at 13:00 in the computer lab (Building A21, Room 104).
- Emergency/Online Meetings: Time and date will be communicated via group chat. Most of these will be held online (Microsoft Teams) for flexibility.

Meeting Conduct

- **Punctuality**: Arrive 5 minutes early. Late arrival of more than 10 minutes requires a valid reason via group chat beforehand. Chronic lateness counts toward delinquency.
- **Agenda**: An agenda will be shared at least 24 hours in advance via the group chat.
- Participation: Everyone is expected to participate by giving ideas and solutions at least once per meeting. One person speaks at a time—no interrupting.
- **Decisions**: Made by agreement where possible, or majority vote when necessary. The group coordinators break ties.
- **Record-Keeping**: Meeting minutes will be recorded by the Documentation Lead and shared within 24 hours.
- **Problem-Solving**: Technical problems encountered should be brought to meetings for group discussion.

Attendance Policy

- If a member cannot attend, they must notify the group at least 24 hours in advance.
- Members who miss a meeting are responsible for:
- Reviewing the meeting minutes.
- Contacting at least two teammates to catch up.
- Completing any assigned tasks by the deadline.

COMMUNICATION AND COLLABORATION

Primary Channels and Response Times

- **WhatsApp**: For instant communication, updates, quick questions, and agenda sharing. Members are expected to check this platform at least once daily (Monday-Friday) and respond to messages within 12 hours (24 hours on weekends). Use "seen" receipts or a thumbs-up to acknowledge messages.
- **Google Drive**: For storing and collaborating on documents.
- **GitHub**: For version control, task tracking, and all project files.

GitHub Expectations

- The GitHub Manager will create a repository and add all members as collaborators.
- All project files must be committed regularly, with meaningful commit messages.
- Members should commit work at least weekly to show progress.

WORK EXECUTION AND DEADLINES

Work Division Strategy

Tasks will be divided according to the strengths and technical abilities of each member. Each major project phase will be divided into smaller, assignable tasks. The group coordinators will monitor progress to ensure fair contribution. If a member finishes early, they are expected to assist others to ensure the project progresses smoothly.

Deadline Philosophy

To ensure quality and allow for review, we will adhere to a multi-tiered deadline system with a 20% buffer:

- **Internal Deadline**: The goal we aim for. This allows time for group review.
- **Buffer Deadline**: The "real" deadline. If life happens, work must be submitted by this date. Missing this triggers consequences.
- **Official Due Date**: The university's hard deadline, which is non-negotiable.

DEFINITION OF DELINQUENCY

With 7 members, one person not contributing has a significant impact. Delinquency is defined as a pattern of behavior where a member consistently fails to meet expectations. This includes, but is not limited to:

- Missing a meeting without 24 hours' notice.
- Arriving more than 30 minutes late to a meeting without prior notice.
- Failing to complete a task by the Buffer Deadline without communication.
- Not pushing updates to GitHub as agreed.
- Consistently submitting low-quality work that requires others to redo it.
- Not contributing to discussions or decision-making.
- Failing to respond to communication within the agreed timeframe

Excused Absences: Illness , family emergencies , or university commitments.

CONSEQUENCES AND DISPUTE RESOLUTION

The "Respect My Time" Fund

We are introducing a fine system to ensure everyone's time is respected. All money collected will go into a group fund for a victory celebration upon project completion.

- R30 for late arrivals (more than 10 minutes).
- R60 for missed meetings without 24 hours' notice.

Fines must be paid within 48 hours via e-wallet/cash to the Group Coordinators, who will keep a log.

The Three-Strike Rule

We want to support each other, but we must also protect the project.

- **Strike 1**: A private, informal check-in from the group coordinators.
- **Strike 2**: A formal notification in the group chat, reminding the member of their commitments. Applicable fines apply.
- **Strike 3**: Accumulating three strikes, or a complete cessation of contribution, will result in the group voting to remove the member. The coordinators will inform the lecturer via email, and the member will be responsible for completing the project on their own.

Dispute Resolution

In case of disagreements, decisions will be made by majority vote; the coordinators break ties. If a resolution cannot be found, the group can appeal to the lecturer.

PROJECT TIMELINE

This is the agreed-upon schedule. Bold dates are official submissions.

Phase	Responsible Person(s)	Internal Deadline
Work Ethics	ALL	12/03: First meeting. 13/03: Submit individual ethics ideas (by 10:00). 14/03: Work on timeline. 15/03: SUBMIT PHASE 2.
Introduction	ALL	16-18/03: Submit ideas in group chat. 19/03: In-person meeting. 20-22/03: Individual work. 23/03: Submit individual contributions. 24/03: Editing/compilation. 25/03: SUBMIT INTRODUCTION.
Literature Review	ALL	26/03: In-person meeting. 27/03-01/04: Submit ideas. 02/04: In-person meeting. 03-05/04: Individual work. 06/04: Submit contributions. 07/04: Editing/compilation. 08/04: SUBMIT LITERATURE REVIEW.
Methodology	ALL	09/04: In-person meeting. 10-15/04: Discussions/decisions in group chat. 16/04: In-person meeting. 17-19/04: Individual work. 20/04: Submit contributions. 21/04: Editing/compilation. 22/04: SUBMIT METHODOLOGY.
Finalization	ALL	23/04: In-person meeting. 24/04 - 02/05: Finalize project, ensure everything is running, polish Packet Tracer file.

FINAL SUBMISSION	Leader	03/05: SELF-IMPOSED SUBMISSION. 04/05: OFFICIAL FINAL SUBMISSION (23:55).
Presentation	ALL	05-06/05: Project presentations.

SIGNATURES

By signing below, we acknowledge that we have read, understood, and agree to abide by this Group Work Ethics Agreement.

Name	**Student ID**	**Signature**	**Date**
Letlotlo Mogatusi	40349136	Lmogatusi	14/03/2026
Ahleli Pilingane	45372039	A. Pilingane	14/03/2026
Fani Mabaso	44330243	F Mabaso	15/03/2026
Thabo Motau	40853942	TP Motau	15/03/2026
Akani Ebenezer Royal Baloyi	47990716	AER Baloyi	15/03/2026
Phetho Tsoeu	45594309	P Tsoeu	15/03/2026
Kgaugelo Pertunia Mabote	41409914	KP Mabote	15/03/2026